FRACTION WORD PROBLEMS: MULTIPLY OR DIVIDE?

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Decide first: is the problem **multiplying** (a fraction of an amount, scaling a recipe, area) or **dividing** (how many pieces fit, sharing equally)? Write the equation, then solve. Show your working.

1. A pancake recipe needs $\frac{3}{4}$ cup of milk. Ava makes 3 times the recipe for a class breakfast. How much milk does she need?

2. A ribbon is 6 feet long. Liam cuts it into pieces that are each $\frac{3}{4}$ foot long. How many pieces does he get?

3. Maya has $\frac{2}{3}$ of a can of paint. She uses $\frac{1}{2}$ of what is left on a chair. What fraction of the whole can did the chair take?

4. A garden bed is 2 $\frac{1}{2}$ meters long and 1 $\frac{1}{3}$ meters wide. What is its area in square meters?

5. Four friends share $\frac{2}{5}$ of a pizza equally. What fraction of the whole pizza does each friend get?

6. Noah runs $\frac{1}{3}$ mile every lap. How many laps does he run to cover 2 $\frac{1}{2}$ miles?

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FRACTION WORD PROBLEMS: MULTIPLY OR DIVIDE? ANSWER KEY

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Decide first: is the problem **multiplying** (a fraction of an amount, scaling a recipe, area) or **dividing** (how many pieces fit, sharing equally)? Write the equation, then solve. Show your working.

1. A pancake recipe needs $\frac{3}{4}$ cup of milk. Ava makes 3 times the recipe for a class breakfast. How much milk does she need?

$\frac{3}{4} \times 3 = \frac{9}{4} = 2\frac{1}{4}$ **cups**

2. A ribbon is 6 feet long. Liam cuts it into pieces that are each $\frac{3}{4}$ foot long. How many pieces does he get?

$6 \div \frac{3}{4} = 6 \times \frac{4}{3} = 8$ **pieces**

3. Maya has $\frac{2}{3}$ of a can of paint. She uses $\frac{1}{2}$ of what is left on a chair. What fraction of the whole can did the chair take?

$\frac{1}{2} \times \frac{2}{3} = \frac{2}{6} = \frac{1}{3}$ **of the can**

4. A garden bed is $2\frac{1}{2}$ meters long and $1\frac{1}{3}$ meters wide. What is its area in square meters?

$\frac{5}{2} \times \frac{4}{3} = \frac{20}{6} = 3\frac{1}{3}$

square meters

5. Four friends share $\frac{2}{5}$ of a pizza equally. What fraction of the whole pizza does each friend get?

$\frac{2}{5} \div 4 = \frac{2}{5} \times \frac{1}{4} = \frac{2}{20} = \frac{1}{10}$

of the pizza

6. Noah runs $\frac{1}{3}$ mile every lap. How many laps does he run to cover $2\frac{1}{2}$ miles?

$2\frac{1}{2} \div \frac{1}{3} = \frac{5}{2} \times 3 = \frac{15}{2} = 7\frac{1}{2}$

laps

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